

Chapter 7 — Women, Caste and Reform

The one-line point: Nineteenth-century reformers fought sati, child marriage and caste — **and their favourite weapon was the ancient text itself**. Then the "lower" castes stopped waiting to be reformed by others and organised **for themselves**. ★ **The richest chapter in the book for GS1 Indian Society.**

← Ch.6 | Index | Next: Ch.8 →

Syllabus Classification

Field	Value
Subject	History → Modern India
Sub-discipline	Social reform movements ; women's question; anti-caste movements
Period	1772 – 1947
Prelims (GS Paper I)	★★★ <i>History of India</i> → reformers, their organisations, and the reform laws with years
Mains (GS Paper I)	★★★★★ "Role of women and women's organisations", "social empowerment", "the Indian Renaissance" — all explicit GS1 syllabus lines
Also feeds	Indian Society (GS1) ★★★, Polity ★★ (Articles 15/17/25, reservation, the Ambedkar–Gandhi debate), Ethics ★★ (dignity, equality, moral courage), Essay ★★★
Weightage	★★★★★ — among the very highest in the entire NCERT History series
Overlaps with	Ch.5 (reform as a 1857 grievance), Ch.6 (education for girls), Ch.8 (reformers and the national movement)

Learning Outcomes

By the end of this chapter you should be able to:

- ☐ **Describe** the condition of women and the caste order c. 1800. ★★
- ☐ **Explain** why **print** changed the nature of social debate. ★★
- ☐ **Describe Rammohun Roy** and the **Brahmo Sabha/Samaj**; state the **sati** ban and its year. ★★★★★
- ☐ **Explain the reformers' STRATEGY** — using ancient texts against present practice. ★★★★★
- ☐ **Name Vidyasagar** and the **widow remarriage law of 1856**, and its limited effect. ★★★★★
- ☐ **List** the reformers who supported widow remarriage across regions. ★★
- ☐ **Explain** why people opposed girls' schooling, and name the pioneers. ★★★★★
- ☐ **Name the women who wrote** — **Tarabai Shinde, Pandita Ramabai, Rokeya Sakhawat Hossain**. ★★★★★
- ☐ **State the Child Marriage Restraint Act, 1929** and its ages. ★★★★★
- ☐ **Explain** what **new opportunities** colonial rule opened for "low" castes. ★★★★★
- ☐ **Name the non-Brahman movements** — **Satnami, Matua, Narayana Guru, Satyashodhak, Self-Respect**. ★★★★★
- ☐ **Explain Phule's argument, *Gulamgiri***, and why he dedicated it to American abolitionists. ★★★★★
- ☐ **Describe Ambedkar's temple entry movement** (1927–35). ★★★★★

- ☐ **State Periyar's position** and why he left the Congress. ★★ ★
- ☐ **Explain the ORTHODOX REACTION** — Sanatan Dharma Sabhas etc. ★★
- ☐ **Summarise the eight reform organisations** in the box. ★★ ★

Start Here: Two Hundred Years Ago

THE CONDITION OF WOMEN, c. 1800

- "Most children were MARRIED OFF AT AN EARLY AGE"
- "Both Hindu and Muslim men could MARRY MORE THAN ONE WIFE"
- In some parts, widows were PRAISED if they chose death by burning on their husband's funeral pyre -- called *** SATI ***,
"meaning VIRTUOUS WOMEN"
...and note NCERT's phrase: *** "whether willingly or otherwise" ***
- "Women's rights to PROPERTY were also RESTRICTED"
- "Most women had virtually NO ACCESS TO EDUCATION"
- *** "In many parts of the country people believed that IF A
WOMAN WAS EDUCATED, SHE WOULD BECOME A WIDOW." ***

★★ ★ And the caste order:

Rank	Groups
"Upper castes"	Brahmans and Kshatriyas
Then	Traders and moneylenders — Vaishyas
Then	Peasants, and artisans such as weavers and potters — Shudras
★ At the lowest rung	"Those who laboured to keep cities and villages clean or worked at jobs that upper castes considered ' POLLUTING ' — that is, it could lead to the loss of caste status "

★★ ★ **The disabilities, listed exactly:** those treated as "untouchable" *"**were not allowed to ENTER TEMPLES, DRAW WATER FROM THE WELLS used by the upper castes, or BATHE IN PONDS where upper castes bathed. They were seen as INFERIOR HUMAN BEINGS.**"*

 **Note the three disabilities — temple, well, pond.** They map exactly onto the three great satyagrahas of the twentieth century (temple entry, Mahad tank, Vaikom) and onto **Article 17** and **Article 15(2)** of the Constitution.

1 ★★ ★ **Why Reform Became Possible: Print**

*"From the early nineteenth century, we find debates and discussions about social customs and practices **taking on a NEW CHARACTER. One important reason for this was the development of NEW FORMS OF COMMUNICATION.**"*

"For the FIRST TIME, *** BOOKS, NEWSPAPERS, MAGAZINES, LEAFLETS AND PAMPHLETS *** were PRINTED."

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"These were FAR CHEAPER and FAR MORE ACCESSIBLE than the MANUSCRIPTS you read about in Class VII."

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- "ORDINARY PEOPLE could READ these"
- "many of them could also WRITE and EXPRESS THEIR IDEAS *** IN THEIR OWN LANGUAGES ***"
- all kinds of issues could be debated by men *** "(and sometimes by women as well)" *** in the new cities

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"The discussions could REACH OUT TO A WIDER PUBLIC, and could become *** LINKED TO MOVEMENTS FOR SOCIAL CHANGE. ***"

★★ This is the mechanism, and it deserves emphasis in a Mains answer. Social reform in India was **not simply an importation of Western ideas** — it became possible because **a cheap, vernacular, public medium appeared**, which allowed argument to escape the closed circles of the learned and reach a reading public.

📖 The cost of publishing collapsed and the audience became addressable. Debate stopped being oral, local and elite, and became **printed, distributed and participatory** — including, crucially, by women who could now write for themselves rather than be written about.

🔗 Compare Class 7 Ch.1 — manuscripts copied by hand, drifting, expensive, elite. **Print reversed every one of those properties.**

2 ★★ ★ Rammohun Roy and the Campaign Against Sati

Fact	Detail
★★ Dates	RAJA RAMMOHUN ROY, 1772–1833
★★★ Founded	The ★ BRAHMO SABHA (later the BRAHMO SAMAJ) in CALCUTTA
★ His aims	"Keen to spread the knowledge of WESTERN EDUCATION in the country and bring about greater FREEDOM AND EQUALITY FOR WOMEN "
On women's condition	"He wrote about the way women were forced to bear the burden of domestic work, confined to the home and the kitchen, and NOT ALLOWED TO MOVE OUT AND BECOME EDUCATED "
His languages	"Well versed in Sanskrit, Persian and several other Indian and European languages "

★★ What a "reformer" meant, in NCERT's definition:

"People such as Rammohun Roy are described as **reformers** because they felt that **changes were necessary in society, and unjust practices needed to be done away with**. They thought the best way to ensure such changes was **by PERSUADING PEOPLE to give up old practices and adopt a new way of life.**"

★ ★ ★ The strategy that defined an era

"He tried to show through his writings that *** THE PRACTICE OF WIDOW BURNING HAD NO SANCTION IN ANCIENT TEXTS. ***"

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"By the early nineteenth century many BRITISH OFFICIALS had also begun to criticise Indian traditions and customs. They were therefore MORE THAN WILLING TO LISTEN to Rammohun, who was REPUTED TO BE A LEARNED MAN."

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*** IN 1829, SATI WAS BANNED. ***

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"The strategy adopted by Rammohun was *** USED BY LATER REFORMERS AS WELL. *** Whenever they wished to challenge a practice that seemed harmful, they tried to *** FIND A VERSE OR SENTENCE IN THE ANCIENT SACRED TEXTS THAT SUPPORTED THEIR POINT OF VIEW. *** They then suggested that *** THE PRACTICE AS IT EXISTED AT PRESENT WAS AGAINST EARLY TRADITION. ***"

★ ★ ★ This is the single most important analytical point in the chapter, and NCERT's own question asks it directly: "how did the knowledge of ancient texts help the reformers promote new laws?"

The reformers did not argue "this custom is wrong because it is backward." They argued "this custom is a corruption of our own tradition." That framing was strategically brilliant for three reasons:

1. It **denied opponents the charge of Westernisation** — the reformer stood on scripture, not on English opinion
2. It made reform an act of **restoration**, not rupture — psychologically far easier to accept
3. It **used the authority of the texts against the authority of the priesthood** that claimed to interpret them

⚠️ **But note the cost, which a sophisticated answer mentions:** it conceded that **ancient texts were the final court of appeal**, so reform could only go as far as a supporting verse could be found. **Phule, Ambedkar and Periyar later broke with this method entirely** — and that break is the real division running through this chapter.

★ **NCERT's true/false makes the point:** "Social reformers had to discard the ancient texts in order to argue for reform" → **FALSE**. They **used** them.

★ **Rammohun's dialogue on sati** — he published pamphlets written as debates between an advocate and a critic:

ADVOCATE: "Women are by nature of inferior understanding... Many of them, on the death of their husbands, become desirous of accompanying them; **but to remove every chance of their trying to escape from the blazing fire, in burning them WE FIRST TIE THEM DOWN TO THE PILE.**"*

OPPONENT: "When did you ever afford them a fair opportunity of exhibiting their natural capacity? How then can you accuse them of want of understanding?... **if you do not educate women how can you see them as inferior.**"*

★★★ The advocate's own words destroy his case, and Rammohun knew exactly what he was doing by printing them. He claims the women go willingly — and in the same breath admits they are tied down so they cannot escape.

And the opponent's reply is a complete argument about structural disadvantage in two sentences: you deny them education, then cite their ignorance as proof of inferiority. That is quotable in any Essay or GS1 answer on gender, and it was written nearly two hundred years ago.

3 ★★★ Widow Remarriage

Fact	Detail
★★★ Who	ISHWARCHANDRA VIDYASAGAR — "one of the most famous reformers"
★★ His method	★ "Used the ANCIENT TEXTS to suggest that widows could remarry"
★★★ The law	"His suggestion was adopted by British officials, and a law was passed in 1856 permitting WIDOW REMARRIAGE "
⚠ The cost to him	"Those who were against the remarriage of widows opposed Vidyasagar, and even BOYCOTTED him "

★★ The movement spread — learn the regional spread:

Region	Reformer
★ Telugu-speaking areas of the Madras Presidency	VEERASALINGAM PANTULU — "formed an association for widow remarriage"
Bombay	"Young intellectuals and reformers pledged themselves to working for the same cause"
★★ The north	SWAMI DAYANAND SARASWATI, who founded the ★ ARYA SAMAJ (1875), "also supported widow remarriage"

⚠ ★★★ And NCERT's honest assessment, which you must include:

"Yet, the number of widows who actually remarried remained LOW. Those who married were NOT EASILY ACCEPTED IN SOCIETY and conservative groups continued to OPPOSE the new law."

🎯 This is the crucial distinction between legal change and social change, and it is exactly the point examiners want. A law was passed; a practice did not change. Deploy this whenever you write about social legislation — from 1856 to dowry law to the Protection of Civil Rights Act, the gap between statute and society is the recurring Indian problem.

4 ★ ★ ★ Girls Begin Going to School

★ ★ Why people opposed it — NCERT asks this directly

"When the first schools were opened in the MID-NINETEENTH CENTURY, *** MANY PEOPLE WERE AFRAID OF THEM. ***"

THE REASONS:

- [1] "They feared that schools would TAKE GIRLS AWAY FROM HOME, PREVENT THEM FROM DOING THEIR DOMESTIC DUTIES"
- [2] "Girls had to TRAVEL THROUGH PUBLIC PLACES in order to reach school. Many people felt that this would have a *** CORRUPTING INFLUENCE *** on them."
- [3] "They felt that girls should *** STAY AWAY FROM PUBLIC SPACES. ***"
- [4] (from the chapter's opening) the belief that *** "if a woman was educated, she would become a widow" ***

★ ★ The consequence, and the workaround:

*"Therefore, throughout the nineteenth century, **most educated women were TAUGHT AT HOME by liberal fathers or husbands. Sometimes women TAUGHT THEMSELVES.**"* — like Rashsundari Debi, who *"secretly learned to read and write in the flickering light of candles at night."*

★ ★ Who built the schools

Founder / body	Where
★ Vidyasagar	Calcutta
Other reformers	Bombay
★ ★ The ARYA SAMAJ	Punjab
★ ★ ★ JYOTIRAO PHULE	Maharashtra

★ ★ In Muslim households:

Fact	Detail
Aristocratic households in North India	Women learnt to read the Koran in Arabic , taught by women who came home to teach
★ MUMTAZ ALI	<i>"Reinterpreted verses from the Koran to argue for women's education"</i> — ★ the same textual strategy as Rammohun and Vidyasagar
★ Urdu novels	<i>"The first Urdu novels began to be written from the late nineteenth century"</i> , meant to encourage women to read about religion and domestic management in a language they could understand
★ ★ The Begums of Bhopal	From the early twentieth century , played a notable role; ★ founded a primary school for girls at ALIGARH
★ ★ ★ BEGUM ROKEYA SAKHAWAT HOSSAIN	★ Started schools for Muslim girls in PATNA and CALCUTTA ; <i>"a fearless critic of conservative ideas, arguing that RELIGIOUS LEADERS OF EVERY FAITH ACCORDED AN INFERIOR PLACE TO WOMEN"</i>

★ ★ ★ **Rokeya Hossain's claim is the most radical formulation in the chapter, and it is worth noticing why.** She did not say *my* religion's leaders, or *their* religion's leaders. She said **every faith's religious leaders** subordinate women — **a structural claim about religious authority as such**, made by a Muslim woman in the early twentieth century. **Superb for Essay and GS1 on gender and religion.**

5 ★ ★ ★ Women Write About Women

"By the 1880s, Indian women began to ENTER UNIVERSITIES. Some of them trained to be DOCTORS, some became TEACHERS. Many women began to write and publish their critical views on the place of women in society."

Woman	Work and contribution
★ ★ ★ TARABAI SHINDE	"A woman educated at home at POONA ", published ★ STRIPURUSHTULNA — "A Comparison between Women and Men" — criticising the social differences between men and women
★ ★ ★ PANDITA RAMABAI	★ "A great scholar of SANSKRIT ", who "felt that HINDUISM WAS OPPRESSIVE TOWARDS WOMEN , and wrote a book about the miserable lives of UPPER-CASTE Hindu women ". ★ She founded a WIDOWS' HOME at POONA to shelter widows badly treated by their husbands' relatives — ★ "here women were TRAINED so that they could SUPPORT THEMSELVES ECONOMICALLY "
★ ★ Begum Rokeya Sakhawat Hossain	(above)

★ ★ Tarabai Shinde's words — quote these:

*"Isn't a woman's life as dear to her as yours is to you? It's as if women are meant to be made of something different from men altogether, **made from dust from earth or rock or rusted iron** whereas you and your lives are made from the purest gold... once a woman's husband has died, what's in store for her? The barber comes to **shave all the curls and hair off her head**, just to cool your eyes... She is **shut out from going to weddings, receptions and other auspicious occasions**... And why all these restrictions? **Because her husband has died. She is unlucky... Her face is not to be seen, it's a bad omen.**"*

★ ★ ★ Note what Ramabai's widows' home actually did — it trained widows to support themselves **ECONOMICALLY**. That is not charity; it is **an attack on the dependence that made widowhood a life sentence**. It anticipates the entire modern argument that **women's autonomy requires economic independence**, and it is a far stronger example than a generic reference to "social reform."

★ ★ The orthodox reaction — both communities

*"Needless to say, all this **more than alarmed the orthodox**. For instance, **many Hindu nationalists felt that Hindu women were adopting Western ways** and that **this would CORRUPT HINDU CULTURE and ERODE FAMILY VALUES**. **ORTHODOX MUSLIMS** were **ALSO worried** about the impact of these changes."*

★ ★ Women organise

*"By the end of the nineteenth century, **WOMEN THEMSELVES** were **actively working for reform**. They **wrote books, edited magazines, founded schools and training centres**, and set up **WOMEN'S ASSOCIATIONS**. From the **early twentieth century**, they formed ★ **POLITICAL PRESSURE GROUPS** to push through laws for ★ **FEMALE SUFFRAGE (the right to vote)** and **better health care and education for women**. Some of them **joined various kinds of NATIONALIST AND SOCIALIST MOVEMENTS from the 1920s**."*

⚠️ ★★★ And a pointed detail worth remembering:

*"Leaders such as **Jawaharlal Nehru and Subhas Chandra Bose** lent their support to demands for greater equality and freedom for women. **Nationalist leaders promised that there would be FULL SUFFRAGE for all men and women AFTER INDEPENDENCE. HOWEVER, TILL THEN THEY ASKED WOMEN TO CONCENTRATE ON THE ANTI-BRITISH STRUGGLES.**"*

🎯 That "however" is doing a lot of work, and NCERT includes it deliberately. Women's demands were **acknowledged and deferred** — postponed to after independence, with the national struggle given priority. **This is the classic pattern in which subordinated groups are asked to wait**, and it recurs with caste (the Ambedkar–Gandhi dispute) in the very next section. **Excellent, nuanced Mains material on the national movement's internal tensions.**

★★★ The Child Marriage Restraint Act, 1929

Fact	Detail
★ Context	"With the growth of <i>women's organisations and writings</i> , the momentum for reform gained strength"; Indian legislators in the Central Legislative Assembly fought for it
★★★ The Act	CHILD MARRIAGE RESTRAINT ACT, 1929 — ★ " <i>passed WITHOUT the kind of bitter debates and struggles that earlier laws had seen</i> "
★★ The ages	No man below 18 and no woman below 16 could marry
★ Later	"Subsequently these limits were <i>raised to 21 for men and 18 for women</i> "

★ "Without the bitter debates that earlier laws had seen" is significant — it measures how far opinion had moved in the century since sati. **And NCERT's sting in the tail: "even today over 20 per cent of girls in India are married below the age of 18."** Law again outrunning practice.

⚠️ **Prelims trap:** the Child Marriage Restraint Act is **1929, not 1829. 1829 is the sati ban.** NCERT asks this as a true/false.

6 ★★★ Caste and Social Reform — The Upper-Caste Reformers

Reformer / body	Action
Rammohun Roy	★ Translated an old BUDDHIST text that was critical of caste
★ The PRARTHANA SAMAJ	"Adhered to the tradition of BHAKTI that believed in the <i>spiritual equality of all castes</i> "
★★ The PARAMHANS MANDALI	Founded in BOMBAY in 1840 " <i>to work for the ABOLITION OF CASTE</i> "

★ A striking detail: "*Many of these reformers were **people of UPPER CASTES**. Often, **IN SECRET MEETINGS**, these reformers would **VIOLATE CASTE TABOOS ON FOOD AND TOUCH**, in an effort to **get rid of the hold of caste prejudice in their lives.***"

🎯 "In secret" tells you the **social cost**. Even convinced reformers could not publicly break commensality rules. **It also marks the limit of upper-caste-led reform**, and explains why the movements in the next section had to come from below.

7 ★★ ★ New Opportunities — Why Change Became Possible

NCERT asks this directly: "in the British period, what new opportunities opened up for people who came from castes that were regarded as 'low'?"

[1] *** MISSIONARY SCHOOLS ***

"Christian missionaries began setting up schools for TRIBAL GROUPS and 'LOWER'-CASTE CHILDREN. These children were thus *** EQUIPPED WITH SOME RESOURCES TO MAKE THEIR WAY INTO A CHANGING WORLD. ***"

[2] *** CITY LABOUR ***

"The poor began LEAVING THEIR VILLAGES to look for jobs opening up in the cities" -- factories, municipalities. New demand: "Drains had to be dug, roads laid, buildings constructed, and cities cleaned" -- requiring COOLIES, DIGGERS, CARRIERS, BRICKLAYERS, SEWAGE CLEANERS, SWEEPERS, PALANQUIN BEARERS, RICKSHAW PULLERS.

[3] *** PLANTATIONS OVERSEAS ***

"Some also went to work in plantations in *** ASSAM, MAURITIUS, TRINIDAD and INDONESIA. ***"

[4] *** THE ARMY ***

"A number of *** MAHAR *** people, who were regarded as untouchable, found jobs in the *** MAHAR REGIMENT. ***
*** The father of B.R. AMBEDKAR taught at an army school. ***"

★★ And the crucial motive NCERT states:

"Work in the new locations was often VERY HARD. BUT the poor, the people from low castes, saw this as an OPPORTUNITY TO GET AWAY FROM THE OPPRESSIVE HOLD that upper-caste landowners exercised over their lives and THE DAILY HUMILIATION THEY SUFFERED."

★★★ This is a genuinely important and often-misunderstood point. People chose **brutal work in a coolie ship or a sewage line over life in the village** — not because the work was better, but because it broke the personal dependence and daily humiliation of caste.

Mobility itself was the freedom. Anonymity in a city, or distance across an ocean, dissolved a bondage that no law had yet touched. **This is why urbanisation and migration matter so much in the history of caste**, and it is superb material for GS1.

★ The shoe example — a nice illustration of the same paradox:

*"Leatherworkers have traditionally been **held in contempt** since they work with dead animals... **During the First World War, however, there was a HUGE DEMAND FOR SHOES for the armies.** ★ Caste prejudice against leather work meant that **ONLY the traditional leather workers and shoemakers were ready to supply army shoes. So they could ask for HIGH PRICES and gain IMPRESSIVE PROFITS.**"*

★ **Madigas** were "an important untouchable caste of present-day Andhra Pradesh... experts at cleaning hides, tanning them for use, and sewing sandals."

🎯 Caste exclusivity, which had been a mechanism of degradation, briefly became a monopoly advantage when the market for the product exploded. **A sharp, memorable example of how economic change unsettled the caste order.**

⚠️ ★ And a reminder of the baseline: in the Bombay Presidency, *"as late as **1829**, untouchables were **not allowed into even GOVERNMENT SCHOOLS**. When some of them pressed hard for that right, they were

allowed to **SIT ON THE VERANDA OUTSIDE THE CLASSROOM** and listen to the lessons, **WITHOUT 'POLLUTING' THE ROOM** where upper-caste boys were taught."*

8 ★ ★ ★ Demands for Equality and Justice — the Non-Brahman Movements

"By the **second half of the nineteenth century**, people from within the **NON-BRAHMAN castes** began organising movements **against caste discrimination**, and demanded **SOCIAL EQUALITY AND JUSTICE**."

★ ★ ★ The four early movements — learn leader, region and community:

Movement	Leader	Where	Among whom
★ ★ SATNAMI movement	GHASIDAS	Central India	Leatherworkers — "organised a movement to improve their social status"
★ ★ MATUA sect	HARIDAS THAKUR	Eastern Bengal	Chandala cultivators — ★ "questioned Brahmanical texts that supported the caste system"
★ ★ ★ Shri NARAYANA GURU	A guru from the EZHAVA caste	Present-day KERALA	"Proclaimed the ideals of unity for his people "; argued against treating people unequally on the basis of caste
★ ★ ★ SATYASHODHAK SAMAJ	JYOTIRAO PHULE	Maharashtra	"Propagated caste equality "

★ ★ ★ Narayana Guru's famous statement — know it:

"**ORU JATI, ORU MATAM, ORU DAIVAM MANUSHYANU**" — "ONE CASTE, ONE RELIGION, ONE GOD FOR HUMANKIND."

★ "According to him, **all humankind belonged to the same caste**."

★ ★ What united them all:

*"All these sects were founded by leaders **who came from Non-Brahman castes and worked amongst them**. They tried to **CHANGE THOSE HABITS AND PRACTICES WHICH PROVOKED THE CONTEMPT OF DOMINANT CASTES**. They tried to ★ **CREATE A SENSE OF SELF-ESTEEM AMONG THE SUBORDINATE CASTES**."*

★ ★ ★ "Create a sense of self-esteem" is the key phrase, and it marks the decisive shift in this chapter.

The upper-caste reformers of section 6 wanted to **remove disabilities imposed on others**. These leaders wanted to **build dignity within their own communities**. The object of reform moved from the **oppressor's conscience to the oppressed person's self-regard** — and that is the difference between reform *for* a group and a movement *of* a group.

9 ★ ★ ★ Jyotirao Phule and *Gulamgiri*

Fact	Detail
★ ★ Born	1827
★ Educated	"He studied in schools set up by CHRISTIAN MISSIONARIES "
Then	"On growing up, he developed his own ideas about the injustices of caste society "

★ ★ ★ His argument — the Aryan thesis inverted

He "set out to ATTACK THE BRAHMANS' CLAIM that they were SUPERIOR to others, SINCE THEY WERE ARYANS."

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PHULE'S COUNTER-ARGUMENT:

- *** THE ARYANS WERE FOREIGNERS ***, who came from OUTSIDE the subcontinent
- they "DEFEATED AND SUBJUGATED *** THE TRUE CHILDREN OF THE COUNTRY *** -- those who had lived here BEFORE the coming of the Aryans"
- "As the Aryans established their dominance, they began LOOKING AT THE DEFEATED POPULATION AS INFERIOR, AS LOW-CASTE PEOPLE"

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THE CONCLUSION:

*** "the 'UPPER' CASTES HAD NO RIGHT TO THEIR LAND AND POWER: IN REALITY, THE LAND BELONGED TO THE INDIGENOUS PEOPLE, THE SO-CALLED LOW CASTES." ***

★ ★ And his own golden age:

"Phule claimed that **BEFORE ARYAN RULE, there existed a GOLDEN AGE when warrior-peasants tilled the land and ruled the Maratha countryside in JUST AND FAIR WAYS.**"

★ "He proposed that **SHUDRAS (labouring castes) and ATI SHUDRAS (untouchables) should UNITE to challenge caste discrimination.**"*

🔗 Compare Birsa Munda's *satyug* in Chapter 4. Both leaders answer present dispossession with a vision of a just past that was stolen — because a claim of **restoration** is more powerful than a claim of novelty. The rhetorical structure is identical; the communities are different.

★ ★ ★ *Gulamgiri*, 1873

Fact	Detail
★ ★ The book	In 1873 Phule wrote GULAMGIRI , meaning SLAVERY
★ ★ ★ The dedication	***Some ten years before this, the AMERICAN CIVIL WAR had been fought, leading to the end of slavery in America . Phule DEDICATED HIS BOOK TO ALL THOSE AMERICANS WHO HAD FOUGHT TO FREE SLAVES , thus establishing a link between the conditions of the 'lower' castes in India and the BLACK SLAVES IN AMERICA. "*

★★★ NCERT asks this directly — "why did Phule dedicate *Gulamgiri* to the American movement to free slaves?" — and the answer is worth stating carefully.

He was making **an argument by equivalence**: caste is not a religious or cultural peculiarity to be reformed gently from within, **it is slavery**, and it warrants the same absolute moral condemnation. **The dedication internationalised the anti-caste cause** and placed it inside a global history of abolition rather than inside a domestic history of Hindu reform.

That is a fundamentally different move from Rammohun's. Rammohun sought a verse in the *shastras*; **Phule sought an analogy with the plantation.**

★★ His breadth — and his critique of nationalism

*"Phule **extended his criticism of the caste system to argue against ALL FORMS OF INEQUALITY.** He was concerned about **the plight of 'UPPER'-CASTE WOMEN, the miseries of the LABOURER, and the humiliation of the 'LOW' castes.**"*

★★★ And his warning to the nationalists — quote this:

*"The Brahmins have **hidden away the sword of their religion** which has cut the throat of the peoples' prosperity and **now go about posing as great patriots of their country.** They give this advice to our Shudra, Muslim and Parsi youth that **unless we put away all quarrelling amongst ourselves about the divisions between high and low... our country will never make any progress...** ★★ **It will be UNITY TO SERVE THEIR PURPOSES, and then IT WILL BE 'ME HERE AND YOU OVER THERE' AGAIN.**"*

★★★ NCERT's activity asks what Phule meant by "me here and you over there again", and the answer is the central tension of the whole national movement.

He is saying: **you ask us to suspend the fight against caste in the name of national unity — and once independence is won, the hierarchy will simply be restored.** Unity is being demanded **on the upper castes' terms and for their benefit.**

🔗 **This is exactly the same structure as the women's suffrage deferral above — concentrate on the anti-British struggle, your demands come later. Phule refused the deferral.** So did Ambedkar and Periyar.

🎯 NCERT's final discussion question — "why were Phule and Periyar critical of the national movement? Did their criticism help the national struggle in any way?" — has a **genuinely two-sided answer.** It **divided** the anti-colonial front, **and** it forced the movement to confront social justice, producing commitments (and eventually constitutional guarantees) it would otherwise have avoided. **Say both.**

10 ★★☆☆ Ambedkar and the Temple Entry Movement

Fact	Detail
★★ Born	Into a MAHAR family
★★★ His childhood	"In school he was forced to sit OUTSIDE THE CLASSROOM ON THE GROUND , and was NOT ALLOWED TO DRINK WATER FROM TAPS THAT UPPER-CASTE CHILDREN USED "
★ Education	"After finishing school, he got a FELLOWSHIP to go to the US for higher studies"
★ Return	"On his return to India in 1919 , he wrote extensively about 'upper'-caste power in contemporary society"
★★★ The movement	"In 1927 , Ambedkar started a TEMPLE ENTRY MOVEMENT , in which his Mahar caste followers participated . Brahman priests were OUTRAGED when the Dalits used water from the TEMPLE TANK ."*
★★★ How many	"Ambedkar led THREE such movements for temple entry BETWEEN 1927 AND 1935 "
★★★ His aim	"His aim was to MAKE EVERYONE SEE THE POWER OF CASTE PREJUDICES WITHIN SOCIETY "

★★ Ambedkar in 1927 — quote this:

*"We now want to go to the Tank **ONLY TO PROVE THAT LIKE OTHERS, WE ARE ALSO HUMAN BEINGS...** Hindu society should be reorganised on two main principles — **EQUALITY and ABSENCE OF CASTEISM**."*

★★★ **Read the aim carefully, because it is frequently misunderstood.** The point of the Mahad tank satyagraha was **not to obtain drinking water** — it was **to demonstrate**. His stated purpose was "*to make everyone SEE the power of caste prejudices.*"

The tactic worked by provoking the reaction. When Brahman priests were outraged that Dalits had drunk from the tank, **the outrage itself was the evidence**. He was not requesting a concession; **he was staging a proof**.

📺 It is a deliberately designed test: perform the ordinary act, and let the system's response reveal what the system actually is. **A demonstration, in the exact sense.**

★ **And note the phrase "we are also human beings."** The demand is not for water, or even for access — **it is for recognition as fully human**, which is precisely how the chapter described the condition of untouchability at the start: "*they were seen as INFERIOR HUMAN BEINGS.*"

1 1 ★★☆☆ Periyar and the Non-Brahman Movement

Fact	Detail
★ When	"In the early twentieth century , the non-Brahman movement started"
★★ Who began it	"The initiative came from those non-Brahman castes that had acquired access to EDUCATION, WEALTH AND INFLUENCE "
★★ Their argument	" Brahmans were heirs of ARYAN INVADERS from the north who had conquered southern lands from the original inhabitants — the indigenous DRAVIDIAN races "; they challenged Brahmanical claims to power

★ ★ ★ E. V. Ramaswamy Naicker — Periyar

Fact	Detail
Background	"Came from a MIDDLE-CLASS family "; ★ "interestingly, he had been an ASCETIC in his early life and had studied Sanskrit scriptures carefully "
★ ★ ★ Why he left the Congress	*"Later, he became a member of the Congress , only to LEAVE IT IN DISGUST when he found that AT A FEAST ORGANISED BY NATIONALISTS, SEATING ARRANGEMENTS FOLLOWED CASTE DISTINCTIONS — that is, the LOWER CASTES WERE MADE TO SIT AT A DISTANCE FROM THE UPPER CASTES. "*
★ ★ ★ What he founded	The ★ SELF RESPECT MOVEMENT
★ ★ His claim	" Untouchables were the TRUE UPHOLDERS of an original TAMIL AND DRAVIDIAN CULTURE which had been subjugated by Brahmins "
★ ★ ★ His conclusion on religion	*"He felt that all religious authorities saw social divisions and inequality as GOD-GIVEN. ★ Untouchables had to FREE THEMSELVES FROM ALL RELIGIONS in order to achieve social equality. "*
★ ★ His targets	"An outspoken critic of Hindu scriptures , especially the ★ CODES OF MANU , the ancient lawgiver, and the ★ BHAGAVAD GITA and the RAMAYANA. He said these texts had been used to establish the AUTHORITY OF BRAHMANS over lower castes and the DOMINATION OF MEN OVER WOMEN "

★ Periyar on women:

*"Only with the arrival of words such as **Thara Mukurtham** our women had become **puppets in the hands of their husbands...** we ended up with such fathers who advise their daughters that **they had been GIFTED AWAY to their husbands** and **they belong to their husband's place.** This is the result of our association with **SANSKRIT.**"*

★ ★ ★ The seating-at-the-feast episode is one of the most telling anecdotes in the book, and it is exam-worthy. Periyar did not leave the Congress over ideology or strategy — **he left because nationalists who preached unity seated him by caste at dinner.** It is Phule's "me here and you over there" happening in real time, and it explains the depth of the anti-caste movement's suspicion of the national movement.

★ ★ And note the pattern across all three leaders: Phule attacked the **Aryan claim**, Ambedkar attacked the **temple**, Periyar attacked the **scriptures themselves.** None of them used Rammohun's method of finding a supporting verse — because their argument was that **the texts were the problem, not the misreading of them.** That contrast, stated plainly, is a strong Mains paragraph.

1 2 ★ ★ The Orthodox Reaction

*"These assertions **did not go unchallenged.** The **forceful speeches, writings and movements of lower-caste leaders** did lead to **rethinking and some SELF-CRITICISM among upper-caste nationalist leaders.** BUT orthodox Hindu society also reacted by founding:"*

Body	Where
★ SANATAN DHARMA SABHAS	The north
★ BHARAT DHARMA MAHAMANDAL	The north
★ BRAHMAN SABHA	Bengal

★ ★ Their object: "to **UPHOLD CASTE DISTINCTIONS AS A CORNERSTONE OF HINDUISM**, and show how this was **SANCTIFIED BY SCRIPTURES**."

*"Debates and struggles over caste **continued beyond the colonial period and are still going on in our own times**."*

🎯 Include the orthodox reaction in any answer on social reform. Reform is usually narrated as a one-way advance; **NCERT is clear that it produced organised counter-mobilisation**, and that the contest is unfinished. That honesty strengthens an answer.

1 3 ★ ★ ★ The Reform Organisations — the Complete Box

Memorise this table. It is the single highest-yield Prelims item in the chapter.

Organisation	Year	Founder / figure	Key features
★ ★ ★ BRAHMO SAMAJ	1830	Rammohun Roy	★ Prohibited ALL forms of IDOLATRY and SACRIFICE ; believed in the UPANISHADS ; ★ forbade its members from CRITICISING OTHER RELIGIOUS PRACTICES ; drew critically on Hinduism and Christianity , examining their negative and positive dimensions. Keshub Chunder Sen a main leader
★ ★ YOUNG BENGAL / Derozio	1820s	★ HENRY LOUIS VIVIAN DEROZIO, teacher at Hindu College, Calcutta	★ Promoted radical ideas and encouraged pupils to ★ QUESTION ALL AUTHORITY ; students attacked tradition and custom , demanded education for women , campaigned for freedom of thought and expression
★ ★ ★ RAMAKRISHNA MISSION	—	★ SWAMI VIVEKANANDA (1863–1902), orig. Narendra Nath Dutta ; named after his guru Ramakrishna Paramhansa	★ Salvation through SOCIAL SERVICE and SELFLESS ACTION
★ ★ PRARTHANA SAMAJ	1867	—	Bombay ; remove caste restrictions , abolish child marriage , encourage women's education , end the ban on widow remarriage ; meetings drew on Hindu, Buddhist and Christian texts
★ ★ VEDA SAMAJ	1864	—	Madras ; inspired by the Brahmo Samaj; abolish caste distinctions , promote widow remarriage and women's education ; believed in one God ; condemned superstitions and rituals
★ ★ ARYA SAMAJ	1875	★ Swami Dayanand Saraswati	"An organisation that attempted to reform Hinduism "; supported widow remarriage ; set up girls' schools in Punjab
★ ★ ★ ALIGARH MOVEMENT	1875	★ SAYYID AHMED KHAN	The ★ Mohammedan Anglo-Oriental College at ALIGARH , later Aligarh Muslim University ; offered modern education including WESTERN SCIENCE to Muslims ; "enormous impact in the area of educational reform"
★ ★ SINGH SABHA MOVEMENT	★ Amritsar 1873, Lahore 1879	—	Sikh reform; ★ rid Sikhism of superstitions, caste distinctions and practices seen as non-Sikh ; promoted education , combining modern instruction with Sikh teachings . ★ Khalsa College, Amritsar , established 1892

★★ On Vivekananda — details NCERT gives that are worth carrying:

- After hearing him at the ★ **World Parliament of Religions at CHICAGO in 1893**, the *New York Herald* reported: "***We feel how foolish it is to send missionaries to this learned nation***"
- "***The first Indian in modern times who re-established the spiritual pre-eminence of the VEDANTA philosophy on a global scale***"
- ★ "***But his mission was NOT SIMPLY TO TALK OF RELIGION. He was extremely pained at the POVERTY AND MISERY of his countrymen. He firmly believed that any reform could become successful ONLY BY UPLIFTING THE CONDITION OF THE MASSES***"
- ★★ His call was for people "***to rise above the narrow confines of their 'RELIGION OF THE KITCHEN' and come together in the SERVICE OF THE NATION***" — a contribution to "*the nascent nationalism of India*"
- ★ His nationalism was "**not narrow**": many problems could be overcome only if **the nations of the world came together on an equal footing**; he urged youth to **unite on the basis of a common spiritual heritage**

★ "**The religion of the kitchen**" is a memorable phrase — Vivekananda's contemptuous term for a religiosity reduced to **rules about food and pollution**. It is a **critique of caste practice from inside the Hindu tradition**, and it pairs well with Basavanna's body-as-temple (Class 7 Ch.6).

Prelims

Topic	The exact thing to know
Rammohun Roy ★ ★ ★	1772–1833; Brahmo Sabha/Samaj , Calcutta; campaigned against sati
★ ★ ★ Sati banned	1829
★ ★ ★ Widow remarriage law	1856 , on Ishwarchandra Vidyasagar's argument from ancient texts
★ ★ ★ Child Marriage Restraint Act	1929; men 18, women 16 (later 21 and 18)
The reformers' strategy ★ ★ ★	Find a verse in the ancient texts and argue the present practice is against early tradition
Veerasalingam Pantulu ★	Widow remarriage association, Telugu areas of Madras Presidency
Dayanand Saraswati ★ ★	Arya Samaj, 1875 ; widow remarriage; girls' schools in Punjab
Girls' schools ★ ★	Vidyasagar (Calcutta), Arya Samaj (Punjab), Jyotirao Phule (Maharashtra)
Mumtaz Ali ★	Reinterpreted the Koran to argue for women's education
Begums of Bhopal ★	Founded a primary school for girls at Aligarh
Rokeya Sakhawat Hossain ★ ★ ★	Schools for Muslim girls in Patna and Calcutta ; religious leaders of EVERY faith subordinate women
Tarabai Shinde ★ ★ ★	Stripurushtulna — "A Comparison between Women and Men"; educated at home at Poona
Pandita Ramabai ★ ★ ★	Sanskrit scholar ; widows' home at Poona ; trained widows to be economically self-supporting
Rashundari Debi	Secretly taught herself to read and write
Paramhans Mandali ★ ★	Bombay, 1840 — for the abolition of caste
New opportunities ★ ★	Missionary schools; city labour; plantations in Assam, Mauritius, Trinidad, Indonesia ; the Mahar Regiment
Satnami ★ ★	Ghasidas, Central India, leatherworkers
Matua ★ ★	Haridas Thakur, eastern Bengal, Chandala cultivators
Narayana Guru ★ ★ ★	Ezhava, Kerala ; " oru jati, oru matam, oru daivam manushyanu "
Phule ★ ★ ★	Born 1827 ; Satyashodhak Samaj ; GULAMGIRI, 1873 , dedicated to American abolitionists ; Shudras + Ati Shudras should unite
Ambedkar ★ ★ ★	Mahar ; returned 1919 ; temple entry movement from 1927 ; ★ three movements between 1927 and 1935
Periyar ★ ★ ★	E. V. Ramaswamy Naicker ; left Congress over caste seating at a feast ; Self Respect Movement ; attacked the Codes of Manu, Gita and Ramayana
Orthodox reaction ★ ★	Sanatan Dharma Sabhas, Bharat Dharma Mahamandal, Brahman Sabha

Topic	The exact thing to know
★ ★ ★ The organisations box	Brahmo Samaj 1830 · Derozio/Young Bengal 1820s · Ramakrishna Mission (Vivekananda) · Prarthana Samaj 1867 · Veda Samaj 1864 · Arya Samaj 1875 · Aligarh 1875 (Sayyid Ahmed Khan) · Singh Sabha, Amritsar 1873 / Lahore 1879; Khalsa College 1892
Vivekananda ★ ★	1863–1902, orig. Narendra Nath Dutta; Chicago, 1893; "religion of the kitchen"

Traps:

- "Social reformers had to discard the ancient texts to argue for reform" → FALSE. They **used** them (NCERT true/false)
- "The Child Marriage Restraint Act was passed in 1829" → FALSE. **1929**; 1829 is the **sati** ban (NCERT true/false)
- "Reformers got full support from all sections of the people" → FALSE. Vidyasagar was **boycotted**; orthodox bodies organised against them (NCERT true/false)
- "The widow remarriage law of 1856 led to widespread remarriage" → FALSE. The numbers **remained low** and remarried widows **were not easily accepted**
- "Periyar left the Congress over its economic policy" → FALSE. Over **caste-based seating at a nationalist feast**
- "Ambedkar's temple entry movement aimed mainly at securing water" → FALSE. Its aim was **to make everyone see the power of caste prejudice**
- "The Arya Samaj was founded in 1828" → FALSE. **1875**, by **Dayanand Saraswati**

Mains

- ★ ★ ★ **GS1:** "Nineteenth-century social reform in India was reform from within tradition; twentieth-century anti-caste movements were a break with it." Discuss — **Rammohun's verse vs Phule's Gulamgiri vs Periyar's attack on the scriptures**
- ★ ★ ★ **GS1 (women):** "Women moved from being the objects of reform to its agents." — Rammohun writing *about* women → Tarabai Shinde, Ramabai, Rokeya writing *as* women → women's associations and suffrage demands
- ★ ★ ★ "Legal change outran social change." — sati 1829, widow remarriage 1856, child marriage 1929, and the persistence of each practice
- ★ ★ ★ "The national movement asked women and lower castes to wait." Examine — the suffrage deferral and Phule's **"me here and you over there again"**
- ★ ★ **GS1:** how **colonial urbanisation, army recruitment and migration** loosened caste more effectively than reform did
- ★ ★ **Polity link:** these movements → **Articles 15, 17, 25**, reservation, and the Constitution's abolition of untouchability

Glossary

Term	Meaning
Sati	"Virtuous woman"; a widow who burned on her husband's pyre
Polluting	Work believed to cause loss of caste status
Reformer	One who seeks to end unjust practices by persuading people to change
Brahmo Sabha / Samaj	Rammohun Roy's reform association, 1830
Stripurushtulna	Tarabai Shinde's "A Comparison between Women and Men"
Gulamgiri	Phule's book (1873), meaning "slavery"
Satyashodhak Samaj	Phule's association for caste equality
Ati Shudra	Those treated as untouchable, below the Shudras
Self Respect Movement	Periyar's movement in the Tamil country
Suffrage	The right to vote
Codes of Manu	The ancient law text Periyar attacked
Sanatan Dharma Sabha	Orthodox body defending caste distinctions

2-MINUTE RECAP

1. **c. 1800:** early marriage, polygamy, **sati**, restricted property rights, almost no education — and a belief that **an educated woman would become a widow**. Those treated as untouchable were barred from **temples, wells and ponds** and "*seen as inferior human beings*."
2. ★ **Print made reform possible** — books, newspapers, pamphlets, **cheap, vernacular and public**, so ordinary people could read and **write in their own languages**, linking debate to movements.
3. ★★ **Rammohun Roy (1772–1833)** founded the **Brahmo Sabha** and showed **widow burning had no sanction in ancient texts**. ★ **Sati banned in 1829**.
4. ★★★ **The strategy that defined the era:** find a **verse in the sacred texts**, then argue the **present practice betrays early tradition**. It made reform look like **restoration** — but conceded that **the texts were the final authority**.
5. ★★ **Vidyasagar** used the same method for **widow remarriage** — **law passed in 1856** — and was **boycotted** for it. Supported by **Veerasalingam Pantulu** (Telugu areas) and **Dayanand Saraswati** (Arya Samaj). ⚠️ **Yet few widows actually remarried**, and those who did **were not accepted**.
6. **Girls' schooling was feared** — it would take girls from domestic duties and expose them to **public spaces**. Most educated women were **taught at home**, or **taught themselves**. Schools came from **Vidyasagar, the Arya Samaj and Phule**; for Muslim girls from the **Begums of Bhopal** (Aligarh) and ★ **Rokeya Sakhawat Hossain** (Patna, Calcutta), who held that **religious leaders of every faith subordinate women**.
7. ★★ **Women began writing:** **Tarabai Shinde's *Stripurushtulna***, and **Pandita Ramabai**, Sanskrit scholar, who founded a **widows' home at Poona** that **trained women to support themselves economically**.
8. ★ **By the 1880s women entered universities**; they formed **associations and political pressure groups** demanding **suffrage**. ⚠️ Nationalist leaders promised full suffrage **after independence** and asked them meanwhile to **concentrate on the anti-British struggle**.
9. ★★ **Child Marriage Restraint Act, 1929** — **18 for men, 16 for women** (later 21 and 18) — passed **without the bitter struggles of earlier laws**.

10. ★★ **New opportunities loosened caste more than reform did:** missionary schools, **city labour, plantations in Assam, Mauritius, Trinidad and Indonesia**, and the **Mahar Regiment**. People took brutal work because it broke **the oppressive hold and daily humiliation** of village caste.
11. ★★★ **Non-Brahman movements:** **Ghasidas'** Satnamis (leatherworkers, central India), **Haridas Thakur's** Matua sect (Chandalas, eastern Bengal), **Narayana Guru** (Ezhava, Kerala — "**one caste, one religion, one god for humankind**"), and **Phule's Satyashodhak Samaj**. All sought to **create self-esteem among subordinate castes**.
12. ★★★ **Phule (b. 1827)** inverted the Aryan claim — **the Aryans were foreigners**, the land belonged to **the indigenous "low" castes** — and urged **Shudras and Ati Shudras to unite**. ★ **Gulamgiri (1873)** was **dedicated to the Americans who fought to free slaves**, equating caste with slavery. He warned that nationalist unity would end in **"me here and you over there again."**
13. ★★★ **Ambedkar**, a **Mahar** who as a child sat outside the classroom, led **three temple entry movements between 1927 and 1935**, aiming to **make everyone see the power of caste prejudice** — *"we now want to go to the Tank only to prove that like others, we are also human beings."*
14. ★★★ **Periyar** left the Congress when **nationalists seated guests by caste at a feast**, founded the **Self Respect Movement**, held that untouchables must **free themselves from all religions**, and attacked the **Codes of Manu, the Gita and the Ramayana** for upholding **Brahman authority and male domination**.
15. ★★ **The orthodox counter-mobilised** — **Sanatan Dharma Sabhas**, the **Bharat Dharma Mahamandal**, the **Brahman Sabha** — to defend caste as *"a cornerstone of Hinduism."* **The struggle continues today.**
16. ★★★ **The organisations:** **Brahmo Samaj (1830)**, **Derozio's Young Bengal (1820s)**, **Ramakrishna Mission (Vivekananda)**, **Prarthana Samaj (1867)**, **Veda Samaj (1864)**, **Arya Samaj (1875)**, **Aligarh (1875, Sayyid Ahmed Khan)**, **Singh Sabha (1873/1879)**.

Test Yourself

Prelims style

1. State whether true or false: (a) Social reformers had to discard the ancient texts in order to argue for reform. (b) Reformers got full support from all sections of the people. (c) The Child Marriage Restraint Act was passed in 1829. → *All three **false**. Reformers **used** ancient texts; Vidyasagar was **boycotted**; the Act was **1929** (1829 was the sati ban).*
2. Consider the following pairs:
 1. Ghasidas — Satnami movement
 2. Haridas Thakur — Matua sect
 3. Narayana Guru — Satyashodhak Samaj → *1 and 2 only. The **Satyashodhak Samaj** was **Phule's**; Narayana Guru worked among the **Ezhavas of Kerala**.*
3. Jyotirao Phule dedicated *Gulamgiri* (1873) to — → *Americans who had fought to free slaves, linking the condition of the "lower" castes in India to black slaves in America.*
4. Ambedkar's temple entry movements were led between — → *1927 and 1935 — three such movements.*
5. Consider the following: 1. Arya Samaj — 1875 2. Prarthana Samaj — 1867 3. Veda Samaj — 1864 → *All three correctly matched.*
6. Periyar left the Congress because — → *At a feast organised by nationalists, seating arrangements followed caste distinctions.*

Mains style

7. *"Nineteenth-century reform worked within tradition; twentieth-century anti-caste movements broke with it."* Discuss. **(250 words)**
8. *"Indian women moved from being the objects of reform to becoming its agents."* Examine. **(250 words)**
9. *"In colonial India, legal change consistently outran social change."* Comment with examples. **(150 words)**
10. Why were Phule and Periyar critical of the national movement, and did their criticism help the national struggle? **(250 words)**

Self-check (out loud, no notes):

- State the reformers' textual strategy and one advantage and one limitation of it.
- Give the year of the sati ban, the widow remarriage law and the Child Marriage Restraint Act.
- Name three women writers and what each wrote or founded.
- Name four non-Brahman movements with leader and region.
- Explain Phule's Aryan argument in three sentences.
- What was the actual aim of Ambedkar's temple entry movement?
- List eight reform organisations with years.